Expense and Travel Policy

Part 1: Claiming expenses

Clause 1.1 Scope and principles. This policy applies to every Corvane employee in Dublin, Lisbon and fully remote roles who spends money on behalf of the company, whether for travel, customer meetings, training or small purchases needed to do their job. The basic principle is that you should be neither better nor worse off because of business spending: Corvane reimburses reasonable costs that are necessary for your work and that you could not have avoided, and it does not reimburse personal costs, upgrades for comfort or fines of any kind, including traffic and speeding fines. All amounts in this policy are in EUR and include VAT. When you spend money in another currency, claim the amount shown on your card statement or, for cash, the amount converted at the rate on the date of the purchase. If you are unsure whether a cost is reasonable, ask your manager before you spend the money rather than afterwards. Managers must not approve claims that break this policy, even when the amount is small. Repeated or deliberate misuse of expenses is treated as a disciplinary matter.

Clause 1.2 Submitting a claim. All expense claims are submitted in Orbit HR under the Expenses tile, and every claim must be submitted within 30 days of the date the cost was incurred. Claims submitted later than 30 days are rejected automatically and can only be reopened with written approval from Finance, which is given only in exceptional circumstances such as long-term sick leave. Create one claim per trip or per event rather than one claim per receipt, add a short business purpose for each line, and select the correct cost centre. Your manager receives the claim for approval in Orbit HR and should approve or return it within five working days. After approval, Finance checks the claim against this policy and either releases it for payment or returns it with a comment. Approved claims are paid with your salary. A claim approved by Finance before the payroll cut-off on the 10th of the month is paid on the 25th of the same month; a claim approved after the cut-off is paid in the following month. If you are leaving Corvane, see hr-offboarding-checklist for the deadline that applies to your final expenses.

Clause 1.3 Receipts and evidence. You must attach a receipt for every expense above EUR 25. For amounts of EUR 25 or less, a receipt is still preferred, but a short description of the cost in Orbit HR is accepted when no receipt was available, for example a small cash payment. A valid receipt shows the supplier name, the date, the amount and, where the supplier is VAT-registered, the VAT amount; a card payment slip that shows only the total is not a valid receipt. Take a clear photo of each receipt and upload it directly to the claim line in Orbit HR. Keep the paper originals for three months after the claim has been paid, because Finance carries out random audits and may ask to see them. If a receipt above EUR 25 is lost, complete the missing-receipt declaration in Orbit HR and ask your manager to confirm the cost. A missing-receipt declaration can be used at most twice in a calendar year. Claims for hospitality involving customers or other guests must also list the names of all attendees and their organisations.

Clause 1.4 Approval limits and corporate cards. Your manager can approve a single claim of up to EUR 2,000. Claims above EUR 2,000 also need approval from the director of your department, and Orbit HR routes them automatically once your manager has approved. You must never approve your own claim, and a manager who travels with their team must not approve a claim that includes their own costs. Employees who travel regularly, normally more than six trips a year, can apply for a Corvane corporate card through Orbit HR with their manager's support. The corporate card is for business costs only. Every card transaction still needs a claim line in Orbit HR, with the receipt rules and 30-day deadline above. Personal spending on the corporate card, even if you intend to repay it, is not allowed, and any personal amount charged by mistake must be reported to Finance within five working days so it can be deducted from your next salary. Cash advances are not offered, except for trips to countries where card payment is not widely accepted; in that case contact Finance at least ten working days before you travel.

Part 2: Business travel

Clause 2.1 Booking travel. All business travel must be approved by your manager before you book, and the approval should be recorded in the trip request in Orbit HR so that Finance can match later expenses to it. Book flights, trains and hotels as early as practical, because late bookings are usually more expensive, and compare at least two options when the price difference may be significant. For flights, economy class is required for any journey with a scheduled flight time under 6 hours. For journeys of 6 hours or more, you may book premium economy, but business class is not reimbursed in any case. One standard checked bag is allowed when the trip lasts more than two nights or when you carry equipment for a customer. For travel between Dublin and Lisbon, book as far ahead as possible and combine meetings into a single trip where you can. Rail is preferred over flying when the total journey takes less than four hours. Taxis are reimbursed when public transport is not practical, for example late at night or with heavy equipment, and the reason must be stated on the claim line.

Clause 2.2 Accommodation. The hotel cap is EUR 180 per night including taxes, rising to EUR 220 per night in capital cities such as Dublin, Lisbon, London, Paris or Berlin. The cap covers the room and any mandatory city tax but not minibar, room service, laundry or entertainment, which are personal costs. If no suitable hotel is available within the cap, for example during a large trade fair, ask your manager to approve the higher rate in writing before you book and attach the approval to your claim. For meals, Corvane pays a per diem rather than reimbursing individual restaurant bills. The meal per diem is EUR 45 per day for travel within your home country and EUR 60 per day when you travel abroad. The per diem covers breakfast if it is not included in the hotel, lunch, dinner and non-alcoholic drinks during the day. On the first and last days of a trip, the per diem is paid in full if you are away for more than eight hours and at half the rate otherwise. If a meal is provided, for example at a conference or by a customer, reduce the per diem for that day.

Clause 2.3 Using your own car. You may use your own car for business journeys when it is cheaper or more practical than public transport, for example when visiting a warehouse customer outside a city, and when your manager has approved the trip. Corvane pays a car mileage rate of EUR 0.35 per km, which covers fuel, wear and tear, and insurance. Mileage is calculated from your normal place of work or from your home, whichever is shorter, and you must record the start point, destination, date and purpose of each journey in your Orbit HR claim, together with the total distance in kilometres. The normal daily commute between your home and your office is never a business journey and cannot be claimed. Tolls are reimbursed with a receipt, but fines are not. Before you use your own car for business, make sure that your motor insurance covers business use, because Corvane does not provide insurance for private vehicles and does not cover any damage, excess or increase in premium. When several colleagues travel to the same place, they should share one car where possible, and only the driver claims the mileage.